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Don't getdeceive

How they work **really** online scams and frauds — and how to protect yourself, your family and your money. A visual field guide distilled from a 100-chapter manual: the psychology, the script, the catalog of 45 types of scams, the payment risk data and the recovery plan.

9
Leave
100
Chapters
45+
Types of scams
36
Data tables
70k
Source words

Free sample · The Scam Defence Report

You are reading the *free sample*. The complete defence is in the guide.

What you have in front of you is the visual report: the psychology of a scam, the seven-step script, the catalogue of scam types, the payment-risk data, the verification checks and the first steps to recovery. That is already a lot — but it is **a distillation**. The complete guide, *Don't Get Fooled* (100 chapters), adds exactly the parts that matter most once the money has already left.

01
Gift cards and Steam cards Why scammers demand them, how the request works, the red flags to recognise, and the first-ten-minutes procedure if you have already scratched and sent the code.
02
Tracing scammers Email headers, IP addresses, WHOIS domain lookups, IBAN and crypto-wallet trails: what you can genuinely do yourself, with the limits explained honestly.
03
Recovering your money Bank recall, chargeback, legal action, insurance — and a clear table of what is recoverable and what is not.
04
Checklists, templates and Italian resources Fill-in tools, bank letters, police reports and complaints, plus Italian and European authority contacts.
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A crime that attacks *feelings*, not intelligence

Scams are one of the largest industries in the world. They reach every country, every age group, every level of education. Doctors, lawyers, bank managers and police officers are all being scammed. The reason è is simple — and è is the most important idea of this relationship.

The thesis

Scammers don't attack your intelligence

They attack your feelings. A scam è a story told to make you act before you think. The defense doesn't è be smarter — è still build time to think.

The staircase

Hundreds of millions of euros, in Italy alone

Reports of online fraud number in the tens of thousands every year in Italy, with losses amounting to hundreds of millions. Across the EU the figure reaches billions; worldwide, some estimates exceed one trillion dollars a year.

The hidden cost

Most scams are never reported

The victims feel ashamed, so the official figures are only what we know. Experts believe that the real total is several times higher than — and behind every statistic there is a person who didn't deserve it.

«A scam è a story told to make you act before you think. Your defense è think anyway.»

The only phrase to remember

In summary

3
Things a scammer wants: money, information, help
10
Psychological buttons pressing
7
Steps into every scam
20
Red gold flags

Part I · Understanding scams

The anatomy of a *scam*

Almost every scam in the world tries to get one of three things from you. You understand this, and you understand the whole machine.

What the scammer is really looking for

Objective 01

Your money

Send money, transfer money, pay a fee, buy gift cards or hand over your bank details for them to take themselves. The most obvious objective 3 and the payment method 4 is always their choice, never yours.

Objective 02

Your information

Sometimes they don't ask for money at all. They want your password, card number, PIN, a code sent to your phone, a copy of your passport or your date of birth — to steal later, open accounts in your name or take over your accounts.

Objective 03

Your help

What surprises people. They want you to receive money, forward a package, buy with your card or open an account. You think you're helping or making money. In reality you are a shield 1 and now the crime 2 is partly in your name.

The ten psychological buttons

Button 01

Hope and greedà

Something for nothing — always «barely credible». Not one billion euros, but fifty thousand. Big enough to change your life, small enough to seem possible.

Button 02

Fear

«Your account è has been hacked.» «C’è a warrant for your arrest.» Fear shuts down careful thinking, and the scammer offers the quickest way to stop it.

Button 03

Love and loneliness

The most powerful button of all, and the cruelest. The victim often defends the scammer, because believing the truth means losing the only person who seems to care about her.

Button 04

Authority

Police, banks, tax authorities: we obey. They use official logos, official language, spoofed caller ID, and near-perfect email addresses. When the authority speaks, we stop doubting.

Button 05

Urgency

«Within 24 hours.» Speedà è is the 4fraudster's ally and the victim's enemy. A deadline is fabricated to keep you from checking.

Button 06

Shame

They are counting on your silence. If you are too embarrassed to tell anyone, no one can warn you and the scam continues unabated.

Button 07

The foot in the door

A small first sì — a small favor, a small payment — makes the next, larger sù4 coherent and natural.

Button 08

The sunk cost trap

You've already paid, so paying once again will finally unlock 233 wins. This is why victims pay again and again.

Button 09

Social proof

A chat group full of «happy» customers, all fake. If everyone does it, it must be safe 3 too bad that 4 all 5 is also the scammer.

Button 10

Illusion of control

«You can withdraw whenever you want.» The panel, the numbers, the VIP levels — all designed to make you feel in control of your money.

The scammer's script — seven steps, every time

1 · The 1st approach, or the 2nd one
Unexpected contact — email, SMS, call, friend request, a «wrong number»
2 · Building trust, or courtship
Warmth, a sad story, «evidence» of earnings, a chat group of fake happy customers
3 · Creating the need
An urgent and emotional reason — and the solution è as long as you send money
4 · The first payment
A small sum, or a piece of information designed to appear harmless
5 · L’escalation
Bigger sums, more pressure, a new deadline every time
6 · L’extraction
Everything — savings, loans, even other people's money
7 · Disappearance, or ghosting
Silence, or a new identity and a new target

Same car, different costume

Type of scam	Step 1 — l’approach	Step 3 — the need
Sentimental	Wrong number or dating app	Sick relative, travel expenses
Investments	Announcement on social media or invitation to a group	Deposit to start earning
Fake job	Job offer on WhatsApp	Training fee, equipment fee
Bank phishing	SMS: «your account è blocked»	Confirm your details or move money
Lottery	Email: «you won»	Fee to unlock the reward
Rentals	Real estate ad below the market price	Deposit before the visit
Technical assistance	Pop-up: «your computer è infected»	Pay 001122 assistance or give remote access

Different story. Same car. Recognize the structure — not the detail — è whatò that protects you.

Part I · Chapter 2

Nothing è new — only the *have changed tools*

To understand modern scams, it helps to know where they come from. From ancient markets to voice cloning with AI, the scam is the same: gain trust, then use it against the person who gave it.

Ancient world
Commerce and travel
Fake goods, fake relics, rigged weights
1800
Mail and telegrams
Spanish prisoner, gold bar, thread scam
1900
Letters and faxes
Letters in advance, fake lotteries
1990
Email
Mass phishing, Nigerian «1 letters, fake prizes
2000
Websites and chats
Fake shops, fake meetings, fake jobs
2010
Social media
Romance scams, identity theft, fake profiles
Since 2017
Crypto and apps
Fake investments, pig butchering, wallet theft
2020
AI
Voice cloning, deepfake video, automatic chat

Each new technology has expanded the scope of the scam — it has never changed the logic.

The scam economy — where the money goes

Stage 01

Your payment

A payment goes out to you. Its type decides how difficult it will be to get it back 1 and the scammer always chooses the most difficult to reverse.

Stage 02

The figurehead

A «money mule» gets it — often recruited with a fake job: «get paid, keep five percent».

Stage 03

The layers

It is moved, usually broken down into smaller sums, across accounts in different countries.

Stage 04

L’collection

Converted to crypto or cash and gone within hours. This is why speed1 matters so much.

Who is behind

The’industry

The «compounds of scams» in Southeast Asia

The largest organized operations are not in Africa. In Myanmar, Cambodia and Laos, gated compounds house hundreds or thousands of workers who run pig butchering, fake investments and romance scams in shifts, with managers, targets and human resources departments. Many of the workers are themselves victims — lured by fake jobs, with their passports confiscated, forced to work under threat of violence.

The subculture

The «Yahoo Boys» and the culture of fraud

In some parts of West Africa, computer fraud has become a subculture that treats fraud as a game and a status symbol. Luxury photographs bought with stolen money, its own slang, music and heroes. It harms everyone, including honest citizens and businesses in the countries where it exists.

«Don't imagine a lone criminal. You might be talking to a person who is themselves a prisoner, reading a script written by someone else, in a building on the other side of the world.»

Chapter 5 — Who are the scammers?

Forty-five ways to be *deceived* — and how to recognize each

The manual's monstrous chapter catalogs every major scam out there. Here they are grouped by the channel through which they arrive, each marked by a level of relative risk taken from how the source itself treats it.

The classics and the big money

The archetypal down payment fraud and high-loss investment frauds that dominate today's losses.

Advance payment fraud (the «419») «Pig butchering» — the mostù dangerous today Fake investments and crypto Forex, trading bots and «guaranteed profit» Ponzi and pyramid schemes Inheritanceà and «deceased client» Fake lottery, prize and competition

Love, loneliness and the long scam

Scams that first build a relationship — often for weeks or months — before the first request for money.

Romance scams and false love Dating app scams Sextortion and blackmail The grandparents scam / family emergency Message «family member's account»

Money, work and the promise of easy earnings

Where the offer of income or credit is the product.

Fake job and work from home Loan and credit scams «Credit repair» and debt cancellation Figurehead — when you become the criminal «Small business grant» «Employment agency» that takes documents

The message in your pocket

Phishing via email, SMS and telephone are the most widespread scams in the world, and the easiest to recognize once you know the signs.

Phishing — emails that steal your life Smishing and vishing — SMS and phone Fake bank calls and «account blocked» Impersonating the police, tax authorities and government Fake deliveries and couriers Tech Support Scams QR code, payment app and POS

Platforms, shops and social media

Frauds that hide inside the apps you use every day, from marketplaces to video platforms.

Fake Online Stores Fraud on marketplaces (Vinted, Subito, Facebook) WhatsApp scams Scams on Telegram Scams on Facebook and Instagram TikTok, YouTube and influencers Rentals and properties Tickets, events and trips

Companies, documents and identities

Scams that target companies, official processes and the cards of a lifetime.

Business Email Compromise (BEC) Invoice Fraud and CEO Fraud SIM swapping and number theft Visas, immigration and documents Fake universities and scholarships Recovering «hacked accounts»

The second attack and the new frontier

The cruelest layer is the scams that prey on those who have already been scammed, and the AI toolkit that powers what's to come6.

Recovery scams — the second attack AI, deepfake and voice cloning Fake charities and disaster relief Animals, puppies and pets Art, antiques and fake gold Pitfalls of Subscriptions and Free Trials «Credit transfer» and reimbursement of energy bills

Risk levels are editorial judgments, not taken from source tables · source: Chapters 9–46

The terms that should make you stop

The «Scammers' Language» table in the manual, in full. These sentences are not mistakes — they are scripts, and each has a purpose.

The word or phrase	What
really means «Urgent», «immediately», «within 24 hours»	We don't want you to have time to think
«Confidential», «don't tell anyone»	No one should be able to warn you
«Small fee to unlock funds»	The first of many payments you will never see again
«Guaranteed profit», «risk-free»	Every investment has a risk; this promise is a lie
«Secure Account»	It doesn't exist; a lie to move your money
«Account è blocked, confirm your details»	We want your password or card number
«Your package cannot1 be delivered»	We want a small payment or your card details
«Pay with gift cards»	We want money that cannot be traced and refunded
«Send it in crypto»	We want money that can't be reversed
«Reply to this personal email, not the official one»	We are not who we say we are

Source: Chapter 8 — The language of scammers

Data · Parts II, V, VI

The numbers that *they matter*

Two figures decide how a scam ends: how reversible the payment method is and how high the victim climbs on the escalation ladder. The source tables, transformed into graphs.

Chart 1 · How è is each payment method reversible?

Recoverabilityà, from «none» to «high». The scammer chooses the payment method precisely because 5 6 at the bottom of this list — the lower è the bar, the better è for him.

Credit card
High
Platform Escrow
Good
Debit card
Average
Virtual card
Contents
Instant payment app
Low
Bank transfer (SEPA)

Very low
Gift card
None
Cryptocurrency
None

Sources: Chapter 6.1 (reversal table) and Chapter 96.3 (payment method security table). The length of the bar è is an illustrative coding of the qualitative assessments of the source.

The quickest way to stop money

Payment type	What can be done	How fast
Payment by card, pending	Cancel or block it	Hours
Card payment, completed	Chargeback request	Days–weeks
SEPA bank transfer, recent	Recall + cooperation between banks	Hours–days
SEPA transfer, older / forwarded	Very difficult	Almost never
Transfer to crypto	Traceable, non-reversible; block on the exchange only with the police	Hours, with the police
Gift cards, not yet used	Reporting to the issuer, sometimes possible	Hours
Gift Cards, Used / Cash	Perse — report to the police urgently	Closed

Source: Chapter 65.1 — Stopping the money. Speed1 decides everything.

The scale of escalation of a romance scam

Requests grow in five stages. The figures from the source show how an initial small commission becomes «all».

€200–500
Phase 1
Visa fee, hospital bill, phone repairs
€1k–3k
Phase 2
Customs for a «gift» sent to you
€5k–20k
Phase 3
Medical operation, urgent travel
€20k+
Phase 4
«Contract blocked, I need help»
All
Phase 5
Endless problems, loans, savings

Source: Chapter 10.3 — Requests for money, in order of appearance.

True or false? Two comparisons to memorize

Real investment	Fake investment
Regulated and registered	It is not found in any registry

Real investment	Fake investment
Returns described as possible	Returns described as certain
Withdraw freely	Withdrawal è always blocked
Documents you can check	Screenshots you can't control
Contact via official channels	Contact only on chat apps
No pressure to decide quickly	Constant pressure and deadlines

Royal institution	How he actually contacts you
Police and Carabinieri	They never ask for money by phone or message
Revenue Agency	Formally, in writing, official channels
INPS	Official portal or mail, not chat
Municipality	Formal alerts, never urgent SMS
Banks	They never ask you to move money to a «secure account»

Sources: Chapter 14.1 and Chapter 28.2 — the two tables to remember before paying or believing.

Case study · L’«trading academy» that è vanished

Chapter 14.4

A couple, a Telegram group and €150,000

An Italian couple in their fifties signed up to a trading academy on Telegram recommended by a friend who had already earned 5 6 6 himself a victim, paid with a small commission to recruit others. They started with €1,000, saw daily profits on the panel and in eight months had invested almost €150,000, including a bank loan and the sale of a’car. When they asked to withdraw, the platform demanded a «unlocking fee of 22%». They paid part of it. Then the site, the group and every administrator disappeared.

Chapter 12.4

An accountant, a «financial analyst» and €200,000

A 40-year-old accountant from Lombardy received a WhatsApp message from a woman who introduced herself as a financial analyst. After three months of daily conversations, he had transferred almost €200,000 to a platform showing a balance of over €300,000 — and told his brother about the «best investment of his life». The withdrawal was refused unless he paid a «tax» of 20%. He borrowed €40,000 to pay for it. Then the site went offline. The funds had crossed several countries to crypto within hours of each transfer. He's still paying off the loan.

«A return of 1□1% per day è impossible and è always a lie. A platform that shows profits that you cannot withdraw is not è a trading platform — è a site with numbers on it.»

The rule of pig butchering · Chapter 12.4

Part III · Fraudster or genuine?

Trust the process, not the*impression*

The old defenses were about noticing mistakes. The new defenses consist of verifying. A person or company that resists being monitored is telling you something.

The twenty red gold flags

1

A stranger contacts you first He chose you as his target

2

C’è urgency or a deadline He doesn't want you to think

3

He asks you for secrecy He doesn't want anyone to warn you

4

The profit is too good to be true That's not true

5

You have to pay money before receiving it The commission è the scam

6

A guaranteed «1 profit or return È a lie by definition

7

Payment by gift card, crypto or bank transfer They want money that can't be reversed

8

It asks for a code sent to your phone Wants to log into your account

9

It asks for your PIN or password No real institution ever does this

10

Asks you to move money to a «secure account» Such an account does not exist

11

The relationship goes too fast È manufactured

12

Rejects a video call, or always has an excuse He is not who he says he is

13

The photographs appear on other profiles They are stolen

14

L’email address è almost, but not exactly, right È a fake domain

15

The site is new, without history È was built to take money

16

No real address, telephone or VAT number There is no real company

17

It is not found in any official register Not è regulated

18

It asks you to install remote access software He wants your device

19

He asks you for money to get a job, a loan or a prize È the down payment fraud trick

20

Asks you to receive and forward money He wants a front man

Source: Chapter 47.1 — The twenty red flags of ’gold

If you have two minutes, check this

What do you control	Where	Time needed
A photo	Reverse image search	1 minute

What do you control	Where	Time needed
A website	WHOIS, reviews, contact tests	5 minutes
A’company	Business register, VAT number	5 minutes
An investment company	List of those authorized by the supervisory authority	2 minutes
An IBAN	Validation, name checking, search	2 minutes
A telephone number	Search, with «scam»	1 minute
An email address	Headers, domain control	2 minutes

Source: Chapter 96.4 — The verification table. Ten minutes of checks cost less than a lifetime of regrets.

The clearest test of all

Remove the ’urgency — and see what happens

Say’ «let me think about it» or «I'll call you back tomorrow». An authentic offering survives a pause. Not a scam, because its entire plan depends on you acting before you think. The reaction tells you everything.

The reaction	What does
mean «Of course, take your time»	Authentic
«How can you not trust me?»	Manipulation
«C’è a new deadline today»	Urgency
«You're wasting my time»	Pressure
Silence, then a new story	Change of script
It blocks you	You were a target

Source: Chapter 54.3 — What the reaction tells you.

Parts V, VI, VII · Recovery

If you have already been *scammed*

Speed matters more than anything else. In the first hours the money can still stop; after a few days, usually not. Do these things in order — and do the thing that *first not* you have to do: never let shame keep you silent.

The first 24 hours — act in this order

Hour 01

Call your bank

Ask to stop or recall the payment. Request the recall in writing and write down the reference. Don't wait for the morning.

Hour 01

Block and freeze

Cancel cards, freeze accounts, change passwords and activate 2FA — from your email, the master key to everything.

First day

Collect the evidence

Screenshots, messages, scammer's IBAN, emails with full headers. Do not erase anything or do «cleaning».

First day

Report to the police

File a complaint or complaint (Chapter 73). The complaint is what opens the doors that an individual cannot open alone.

Stop the money — what è and what è is not possible

Your situation	The right step, in order
Money taken without your authorization	Report it to the bank immediately, ask for a refund, then the police
You were deceived and authorized a transfer	Report quickly to bank and police; recall and chargeback routes
You paid an online seller and received nothing	Rights of the Consumer Code, the platform, AGCM, a consumer association
A seller in another EU country	ECC-Net Italia
Your personal data has been misused	Guarantor for the protection of personal data
Do you want compensation from the scammer	Civil action, or civil party in criminal proceedings

Source: Chapter 90 — Insurance and compensation, table by situation.

The recovery scam — the 1attack that comes second

Anyone who offers to get your money back for an upfront fee is again a thief. Victims are the easiest targets, because they are the most desperate. The warning signs are unmistakable.

Signal 01

Contacts you first

The real recovery work doesn't start with an outgoing call. If someone found you, ask how — and why é right now.

Signal 02

Promises recovery

No one can promise recovery of stolen funds. Not a lawyer, not a firm, not an IT specialist.

Signal 03

Wants a commission upfront

True professionals charge for their time, or take a percentage of what is recovered - never an advance payment.

Signal 04

Asks for crypto or gift cards

No legitimate service requires payment in this way. Never.

Signal 05

Perfect and anonymous reviews

Real reviews cite difficulties, delays, and failures. A wall of spotless five-star posts è written by its owner.

Signal 06

He wants documents and urgency

It asks for your bank details, a document and keys — and a decision before you can check out. Both are the mark of fraud.

You're not stupid

The truth

You were attacked by a professional

Every scam in the source manual is carried out by people who do it for a living, who have done it hundreds of times, and who study human feelings like an engineer studies a machine. If someone trained all day to deceive you, and you trusted them for a few days, it's their fault, not yours.

What a victim says	What
usually means «They hacked me»	Often a reused password, or a given code
«He stole my identityà»	Documents or personal data have been used
«The bank said that nothing canò be done»	Ask again, in writing, and escalate
«The police did not respond»	The reports are not updates on the case; ask in writing
«È it was my fault»	It wasn't
«I feel stupid»	You have been deceived by a professional

Source: Chapters 74.2 and 98.2 — Emotional recovery, and the words victims use.

The ten rules to remember forever

Rule 01

Slow down

Every scam depends on speed. Time is your strongest defense.

Rule 02

Never pay money to receive money

Any upfront fee — for a prize, a’inheritanceà, a loan or a job — è a scam.

Rule 03

Never give a code, PIN or password

No bank, police officer or technician needs it. The code on your phone is è just for you.

Rule 04

There is no such thing as a «secure account»

Anyone who asks you to move your money to protect it is stealing it.

Rule 05

Check via a channel of your choice

Hang up and call back on a number you found yourself. Never trust the number or link in the message.

Rule 06

Trust the process, not the impression

Judge with controls, not with feelings. A person who resists being controlled is telling you something.

Rule 07

If it's too good to be true, don't è

A guaranteed profit, a prize with a commission, a stranger who loves you in a week: none of this is real.

Rule 08

Preserve the evidence and act quickly

In the early hours, call your bank. Don't delete anything. Report to the police.

Rule 09

Don't be ashamed and don't be silent

Talk to someone about it. Shame protects the deceiver; the opening defeats him.

Rule 10

Watch out for the second scam

Anyone who offers to get your money back for an upfront fee is a thief, again.

Source: Chapter 100 — Final Words: Ten Rules to Remember Forever

Part VIII · Special section for Italian readers

Who to call in *Italy* — and what each

does The right entity depends on the problem. Going to the wrong office costs days you might not have. This is the source map of the Italian and European authorities, in the order in which to use them.

Matrix · your problem → the right’entity

Your problem	The right thing, in order
Online fraud, phishing, identity theft	Postal Police, then report to any police station
A payment or transfer to stop	Your bank first, then the ABF if the bank refuses
An’investment offer	Consob, to control the company, then the police if fraudulent
An incorrect shop or a misleading advertisement	AGCM, and a consumer association
A dispute with a foreign seller in the EU	ECC-Net Italia
Improper use of your personal data	Guarantor for the protection of personal data
An insurance problem	IVASS, and the insurance arbitrator
A bank that refuses to help	ABF, and the complaints channel of the Banca d’Italia

Source: Chapter 71.1–71.6

The directory

Police and justice

Postal Police — specialist service for online crimes, with the P.S. Commissariat portal. Online. **Carabinieri** and **State Police** — report at any station. **Financial Police** — financial crime. **Public Prosecutor's Office** — lawsuit.

Financial authorities

Banca d’Italia — banking supervision, complaints channel. **Consob** — market authorities, list of authorized companies. **ABF** — free banking arbitrator. **OAM** — credit agents and brokers. **IVASS** — insurance.

Consumption, data and competition

AGCM — unfair practices, misleading advertising. **Privacy Guarantor** — data protection. **Consumer associations** — free consultancy, collective action. **ECC-Net Italia** — cross-border disputes in the’EU.

European and international

Europol — cross-border police cooperation. **Eurojust** — judicial cooperation. **ECC-Net** — European Consumer Centres. **EBA** — European banking rules. **Interpol** — international police.

Cultural notes — whyé the Italian reader è is targeted, and the strengths to use

Trust

Institutions, and how trust is used

Deep, earned trust in institutions is a strength and leverage. Scammers borrow state logos, forms, and tone because those signals travel faster.

Family

The force and the trap

The closeness of Italian families is a powerful defense 1 and the exact emotion that the grandparents' scam targets. Turn it outward: agree on a family watchword and make the control normal.

Shame

How to dissolve it

Shame is the scammer's greatest ally, because it keeps victims silent and unreachable. Naming her — «è happened to thousands of people, not è your fault» — è whatò breaks her power.

Source: Chapter 94 — Cultural notes for Italian readers

Complete index

All nine parts, all one hundred *chapters*

The complete structure of the source manual is a navigable map of everything, from what is a scam to the ten rules to remember forever.

Parte I · Understanding scams

1. What is a scam? The unvarnished truth
2. A brief history of fraud, from letters to the Internet
3. The psychology of fraud: why smart people fall for it
4. The scammer's script: the seven steps of every scam
5. Who are the scammers? The truth about Nigeria and the world
6. The economy of fraud: how money moves
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11. Fake charities and disaster relief
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14. Fake bank calls and \u201your account is blocked”
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16. Fake Online Stores
17. Marketplace fraud: Vinted, Subito, Facebook Marketplace
18. Rental and property scams
19. Loan and credit scams
20. Impersonating the police, tax authorities and government
21. WhatsApp scams
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Source: manual index · 9 parts · 100 chapters · 36 tables · ~70,000 words


Benito Russo, cybersecurity analyst
The author

Who is *Benito Russo*

A cybersecurity analyst with over fifteen years of experience, Benito Russo advises banks and financial institutions on fraud prevention. In the field he has investigated hundreds of real cases — phishing and fake bank websites, wire-transfer fraud, demands for gift cards and Steam cards, crypto scams — and has helped many victims file a report, start a chargeback and handle mediation with their bank.

He wrote *Don’t Get Fooled* because, in Italian, there was no practical guide that said what to actually do, in the right order, once the money has already left.

Cybersecurity analystFraud investigatorMoney-recovery advisorConsumer-protection advocateEducator and trainer
Read the complete guide

End of the sample · Now the part that protects your money

That was the *sample*. The complete guide is what you use when it actually matters.

The report you just read teaches you to **recognise** a scam. The guide, *Don’t Get Fooled*, also teaches you how to **respond**: what to do in the first hours, how to trace a payment, how to file a report, and what can realistically be recovered. One hundred chapters, nine parts, fill-in tools.

Not in this sample

Gift cards and Steam cards, the request script, and the emergency procedure if you have already paid.

Not in this sample

The full technical chapter: headers, IPs, WHOIS, IBAN, crypto wallets, and building an evidence file.

Not in this sample

Realistic recovery: bank recall, chargeback, legal action and insurance, with honest expectations.

And also

Checklists, letter templates, police report and complaint forms, Italian and European authority contacts — the practical tools that turn awareness into action.

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Don't get *deceive*

About this report

A visual field guide distilled from the 100-chapter manual *Don't be fooled — Complete Guide to Online Scams and Fraud*, written for Italian readers. Structure, statistics, tables and case studies are taken from the source; the layout, graphics and navigation are the contribution of this edition.

Contents

- The anatomy of a scam
- The catalog of scams
- The numbers
- Scam or authentic?
- If you have been scammed
- Complete index

Golden Rules

- Slow down — time è your defense
- Never pay money to receive money
- Never give a code, PIN or password
- There is no such thing as a «secure account»
- Check via a channel of your choice
- Don't be ashamed and don't be silent

The Scam Defense Report · Visual Edition · MMXXVI ❧ · Compiled by «Don't be Fooled» — for informational purposes only, not è legal or financial advice.

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